গবেষণা, পরীক্ষণ ও কনসালটেনসি কেন্দ্র
পুর ও পরিবেশ কৌশল বিভাগ
শাহজালাল বিজ্ঞান ও প্রযুক্তি বিশ্ববিদ্যালয়
সিলেট-৩১১৪, বাংলাদেশ।
যোগাযোগঃ +৮৮ ০১৩১৮ ২১০ ২৮৬/২৮৭/২৮৮/২৮৯/২৯০
Website: www.crtc-cee-sust.com

Center for Research, Testing and Consultancy
Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering
Shahjalal University of Science and Technology
Sylhet-3114, Bangladesh.
Contact: +88 01318 210 286/ 287/ 288/ 289/ 290
Email: crtc-cee@sust.edu

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SUB-SOIL INVESTIGATION REPORT

FOR THE PROPOSED
CONSTRUCTION OF 06 STORIED RESIDENTIAL BUILDING
AT AL AMIN R/A, PATHANTULA, SYLHET

[DAG # BS-9565, KHA # BS/DP-2894, J.L. # BS-75, MOUJA- BAGBARI]

CLIENT

SYED JAMAL AHMED
ROWSHON ARA
CHOWDHURY MD. SHOFIUL HASSAN
SABIHA AFRIN
MOHAMMAD MIZENUR RAHAMAN
MOHAMMAD SHAHIDUL HOQUE
NUR NAHER

CONDUCTED BY

CENTER FOR RESEARCH TESTING & CONSULTANCY
DEPARTMENT OF CIVIL & ENVIRONMENTAL ENGINEERING
SHAHJALAL UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY, SYLHET

SAMPLE COLLECTRD BY
M/S RELATION SOIL INVESTIGATION
Kumarpara, Sylhet.
Mob : 01711063018 & 01712186249

Introduction

A reasonably accurate conception about the sub-soil parameters of any project site is an essential prerequisite for proper planning and designing the foundation of the structure so that the same after its construction would remain safe and serviceable. A detailed study on the sub-surface elements in this regard would necessary to select proper type of foundation.

Objectives

The purpose of sub-soil investigation program is to obtain the following information

1. To classify the formation of soil layers
2. To estimate the safe bearing capacities of the foundation at different soil layers
3. To suggest the safe and appropriate type of foundations.

Scope of work

Centre for research, testing and consultancy (CRTC), Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering, Shahjalal University of Science & Technology (SUST), Sylhet; execute only the laboratory tests and other computational works with the supplied disturbed and/or undisturbed samples to determine the geotechnical properties of the soil.

Table 1: Items of the supplied samples

No	Name	Bore hole no	Depth	Quantities
01	Disturbed sample	01	0-50 ft	10
02	Disturbed sample	02	0-60 ft	12
03	Disturbed sample	03	0-60 ft	12
04	Disturbed sample	04	0-50 ft	10
05	Disturbed sample	05	0-55 ft	11

Laboratory Classifications

The disturbed soil samples, supplied by the client were thoroughly examined and classified roughly (color and type) and noted in accordance with bore hole (BH) and depth (Please see enclosed Tables).

Laboratory Works & Analysis

In addition to visual examination of the sample, Bearing Capacity of soil samples including skin friction & end bearing were calculated.

Bearing capacity for shallow foundation

The N value gives useful information with regards to consistency of cohesive soil and relative density of cohesion less soil. These relationships are given in the following Tables for cohesive and cohesion less soil, respectively.

Table 2: Relation of N-value with the Consistency and the Unconfined Compressive Strength of Cohesive Soils (after Bowles 1997)

N-values	Consistency	Unconfined Compressive Strength (q_u)	
		tsf	kPa
0-2	Very soft	0 to 0.25	0 to 25
3-5	Soft	0.25 to 0.50	25 to 50
6-9	Medium	0.50 to 1	50 to 100
10-16	Stiff	1 to 2	100 to 200
17-30	Very stiff	2 to 4	200 to 400
>30	Hard	>4	>400

Table 3: N and ϕ Relation to Relative Density for Fine Sand (after Bowles 1997)

N values	Compactness	Relative Density, Dr %	ϕ (degree)	Unit Weight (pcf)
1 – 2	Very Loose	0 – 15	26 – 28	70 – 100
3 – 6	Loose	15 – 35	28 – 30	90 – 115
7 – 15	Medium	35 – 65	30 – 34	110 – 130
16 – 30	Dense	65 – 85	33 – 38	110 – 140
>30	Very Dense	>85	>50	130 – 150

Table 4: N and ϕ Relation to Relative Density for Medium Sand (after Bowles 1997)

N values	Compactness	Relative Density, Dr %	ϕ (degree)	Unit Weight (pcf)
2 – 3	Very Loose	0 – 15	27 – 28	70 – 100
4 – 7	Loose	15 – 35	30 – 32	90 – 115
8 – 20	Medium	35 – 65	32 – 36	110 – 130
21 – 40	Dense	65 – 85	36 – 42	110 – 140

Table 5: N and ϕ Relation to Relative Density for Coarse Sand (after Bowles 1997)

N values	Compactness	Relative Density, Dr %	ϕ (degree)	Unit Weight (pcf)
3 – 6	Very Loose	0 – 15	28 – 30	70 – 100
5 – 9	Loose	15 – 35	30 – 34	90 – 115
10 – 25	Medium	35 – 65	33 – 40	110 – 130
26 – 40	Dense	65 – 85	40 – 50	110 – 140
>40	Very Dense	>85	>50	130 – 150

<u>Bearing capacity for deep foundation</u>

Foundations, preferably piles are considered to transmit heavy load from superstructure to deep and hard strata. As the formation of soil strata consists of cohesive and non-cohesive type, the evaluation criteria for the determination of skin friction and the end bearing capacities of piles also vary. Details of the evaluation are provided in the following sub-headings.

Table 6: Formula Used to Determine Bearing Capacity of Soil

Shallow Foundation	
For Cohesive Soil	
(Common Practice)	Where, =Allowable bearing capacity, = Unconfined Compressive Strength, = Unit Weight of soil, = Depth of footing
For Cohesion less Soil	
	= Ultimate bearing capacity in kPa, = SPT Number, = Factor of Safety
Source: Bowles, J. E. (1984), "Physical and Geotechnical Properties of Soils", 2nd Edition	
Deep Foundation	
For Cohesive Soil	
	Adhesion factor, Ultimate skin friction, Undrained Shear Strength, Ultimate end bearing of pile, Bearing capacity factor for deep foundation= 9
For Cohesion less Soil	
	Ultimate skin friction, Ultimate end bearing of pile, = SPT Number
Source: Rajapakse R.A. (2008), "Geotechnical Engineering Calculations and Rules of Thumb"	

Based on the above formula, the important parameters for foundation design have been determined and are given in **Table 7**, **Table 8, Table 9, Table 10 and Table 11** respectively.

Table 7: The allowable bearing capacity for shallow foundation in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Bore Hole No.	Depth	Design N	Clay						Sand
			Continuous			Square(Isolated)			
	(ft)	-	D/B=0.25	D/B=0.5	D/B=1	D/B=0.25	D/B=0.5	D/B=1	
BH01	2.5-5.0	3	0.348	0.366	0.399	0.411	0.444	0.483	0.375
	5.0-10	2	0.252	0.265	0.289	0.298	0.322	0.350	0.272
BH02	2.5-5.0	2	0.186	0.195	0.213	0.219	0.237	0.258	0.200
	5.0-10	1	0.108	0.114	0.124	0.128	0.138	0.150	0.116
BH03	2.5-5.0	1	0.116	0.122	0.133	0.137	0.148	0.161	0.125
	5.0-10	6	0.672	0.707	0.770	0.794	0.857	0.933	0.724
BH04	2.5-5.0	5	0.557	0.586	0.638	0.658	0.710	0.773	0.600
	5.0-10	6	0.692	0.728	0.793	0.817	0.883	0.960	0.746
BH05	2.5-5.0	5	0.580	0.610	0.665	0.685	0.740	0.805	0.625
	5.0-10	15	1.700	1.788	1.949	2.008	2.169	2.359	1.832

Table 8: The allowable skin friction for Precast driven piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole									
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03	BH04	BH05	BH06	BH07	BH08	BH09	BH10
5	0.025	0.049	0.025	0.049	0.074	-	-	-	-	-
10	0.156	0.074	0.049	0.156	0.118	-	-	-	-	-
15	-	-	-	0.096	0.138	-	-	-	-	-
20	-	-	0.120	0.156	0.256	-	-	-	-	-
25	0.468	-	-	0.096	0.118	-	-	-	-	-
30	0.240	0.128	0.072	0.112	0.232	-	-	-	-	-
35	0.308	0.224	0.160	0.224	0.200	-	-	-	-	-
40	0.216	0.216	0.128	0.216	0.224	-	-	-	-	-
45	0.208	0.128	0.096	0.208	0.208	-	-	-	-	-
50	0.200	0.112	0.118	0.200	0.200	-	-	-	-	-
55	-	0.192	0.192	-	0.192	-	-	-	-	-
60	-	0.184	0.184	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Table 9: The allowable end bearing for Precast driven piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole									
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03	BH04	BH05	BH06	BH07	BH08	BH09	BH10
5	0.225	0.450	0.225	0.450	0.675	-	-	-	-	-
10	1.575	0.675	0.450	1.575	1.125	-	-	-	-	-
15	-	-	-	0.900	1.350	-	-	-	-	-
20	-	-	24.000	1.575	51.200	-	-	-	-	-
25	7.875	-	-	19.200	1.125	-	-	-	-	-
30	3.825	25.600	14.400	22.400	46.400	-	-	-	-	-
35	5.175	44.800	32.000	44.800	40.000	-	-	-	-	-
40	43.200	43.200	25.600	43.200	44.800	-	-	-	-	-
45	41.600	25.600	0.900	41.600	41.600	-	-	-	-	-
50	40.000	22.400	1.125	40.000	40.000	-	-	-	-	-
55	-	38.400	38.400	-	38.400	-	-	-	-	-
60	-	36.800	36.800	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Table 10: The allowable skin friction for Bored piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole									
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03	BH04	BH05	BH06	BH07	BH08	BH09	BH10
5	0.016	0.032	0.016	0.032	0.048	-	-	-	-	-
10	0.101	0.048	0.032	0.101	0.077	-	-	-	-	-
15	-	-	-	0.062	0.090	-	-	-	-	-
20	-	-	0.078	0.101	0.166	-	-	-	-	-
25	0.304	-	-	0.062	0.077	-	-	-	-	-
30	0.156	0.083	0.047	0.073	0.151	-	-	-	-	-
35	0.200	0.146	0.104	0.146	0.130	-	-	-	-	-
40	0.140	0.140	0.083	0.140	0.146	-	-	-	-	-
45	0.135	0.083	0.062	0.135	0.135	-	-	-	-	-
50	0.130	0.073	0.077	0.130	0.130	-	-	-	-	-
55	-	0.125	0.125	-	0.125	-	-	-	-	-
60	-	0.120	0.120	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Table 11: The allowable end bearing for Bored piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole									
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03	BH04	BH05	BH06	BH07	BH08	BH09	BH10
5	0.101	0.203	0.101	0.203	0.304	-	-	-	-	-
10	0.709	0.304	0.203	0.709	0.506	-	-	-	-	-
15	-	-	-	0.405	0.608	-	-	-	-	-
20	-	-	10.800	0.709	23.040	-	-	-	-	-
25	3.544	-	-	8.640	0.506	-	-	-	-	-
30	1.721	11.520	6.480	10.080	20.880	-	-	-	-	-
35	2.329	20.160	14.400	20.160	18.000	-	-	-	-	-
40	19.440	19.440	11.520	19.440	20.160	-	-	-	-	-
45	18.720	11.520	0.405	18.720	18.720	-	-	-	-	-
50	18.000	10.080	0.506	18.000	18.000	-	-	-	-	-
55	-	17.280	17.280	-	17.280	-	-	-	-	-
60	-	16.560	16.560	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

On the basis of analysis and information provided by the owner following recommendations are suggested for the proposed three storied residential building.

Soil profile scenario

Overall soil information of the investigated site is irregular in between the boreholes and also vertical inconsistency exists in the soil formation.

Gray sandy clay with very low bearing capacity exists at the upper layers up to 10- 20 ft from the EGL. After that, black organic soil exists near bore holes 1, 2 and 3. Gray fine sand with silt & clay layers with medium bearing capacity are found at different layers from 20 to 40 ft from EGL. Below these layers gray fine sand with good bearing capacity was found, although a soft layer of clay is found at 45- 50 ft near borehole 3. Detailed scenario is provided with the report (please see attached bore-log profiles with SPT values).

Foundation options

In this situation, the foundation should be selected considering both the dimension and design load for the proposed building. Since sandy clay with low bearing capacity was found at top layers along with layer(s) of black organic soil, proper ground improvement is needed before adopting any shallow foundation. The bearing capacity for shallow foundation which is given in the **table 7** is based on existing soil condition. However, client need to reassess the improved bearing capacity of the prepared ground after implementing soil improvement technique in the top layer as mentioned above.

Pile foundation is better option in this case to avoid the soft layers and black organic layers. Size and depth of the pile should be selected in the light of bearing capacity given in the report (Tables 8 & 9 are provided for precast piles, and Tables 10 & 11 are provided for cast in situ piles).

Safety provisions

It is strongly recommended to check the **settlement** of the site considering building load while designing either shallow or deep foundation. Obviously **pile load test** covering the entire project area must be carried out for confirming the design parameters of the service pile (*if pile foundation is considered*). Moreover, the earthquake vulnerability of the project area as well as the quality management of the construction work including workmanship should be taken into account for the safe design of shallow or deep foundation.

Attachments

The layout of the bore holes of the investigated site and the bore-log profiles with SPT values are attached in the Appendix. Client performed no special laboratory test for the proposed site.

Special notes

These suggestions are absolutely tentative and selection of type, depth and dimensions of foundation would be decided by the Consultant or Design Engineer. It is also to be noted that the above recommendation is restricted only to the existing soil condition of 50-60 ft as client provided.

Report Prepared By	**Test Assisted By**	**Counter Signed By**
Dr. Mushtaq Ahmed	**A. H. M. Humayun Kabir**	**Dr. HMA Mahzuz**
Professor Dept. of CEE, SUST	Senior Technical Officer Dept. of CEE, SUST	Coordinator, CRTC Professor, Dept. of CEE, SUST